



RIGHTSIZE. RIGHT SUPPORT. **RIGHT** *for* **STUDENTS.**

A family guide to the proposed school changes

Every school is a community. A school change can affect friendships, routines, programs, and a family's sense of belonging. This guide explains what is proposed and why.

Scenarios A and B are proposals, not final decisions. "No changes proposed" means these options do not include a change for that school.

Each school has a snapshot and a box explaining the reasons for the proposal. The next page shows enrollment estimates, programs, student groups, and maps. Estimates cover 2027-28 through 2031-32. They are not current student counts.

The possible benefits are goals. A larger school does not automatically get a full-time librarian, certain staff, or specific programs. Those details depend on the district's staffing rules, budget, and plans for making the changes.

A school or program move does not determine where an individual student receiving special education services will go. Families and school teams would need to plan each student's services and support.

The school details, numbers, and maps come from PPS school profiles. This guide explains that information in simpler language.

Words you may see in this guide

No changes

What is expected if the district keeps the current schools and programs.

Option A / Option B

The two scenarios. "A and B" means the same information applies to both.

School boundary

The area used to assign students to a neighborhood school based on where they live.

School communities joining

Students from two or more schools would come together. The proposal says which school building would close.

Programs joining

A program would come together at one school or move to another school.

DLI

Dual Language Immersion: learning in English and another language.

School size goal

More than 360 students for K-5 schools; more than 500 for K-8 or middle schools; more than 1,100 for high schools. These are planning goals, not ratings of school quality.

Space use goal

The district aims to use 70%-100% of a school's available room for students. A "No" can mean the school is below or above that range.

Title I

Federal money that supports schools serving students from low-income households. The guide shows the expected designation.

IEP

An Individualized Education Program: a written plan for a student's special education services and support.

Choice program

A program with a special focus, such as arts or science. It may serve families beyond a neighborhood school boundary.

Student groups

Groups can overlap. Do not add the percentages together.

**You may notice slight differences in student numbers and/or demographics in schools that don't experience change because a focus option school has changed and we assume that students return to their neighborhood school.*

BUCKMAN

School proposal | Options A and B

SCHOOL SNAPSHOT	DETAILS
Current program	K-5 neighborhood & arts choice program
Expected enrollment with no changes	244 in 2027-28; 239 in 2031-32
District school size goal	More than 360 students (general district goal)
Students living within 1 mile	82.0%
Building notes	Repair needs are described below.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

The Buckman building needs major repairs. The school requires urgent structural fixes and heavy maintenance to make it safe and modern.

Enrollment is dropping. Buckman is expected to drop to just 239 students over the next few years, making it difficult to fund full programs and staffing.

Nearby schools are in better shape. Both Abernethy and Sunnyside have better buildings and are in good locations to welcome Buckman families.

This is a proposal, not a final decision.

What is being proposed?

Buckman School would close as a school building. The Arts special-focus choice program would close. Neighborhood boundary split: Half of the neighborhood goes to Abernethy K-5: Students living north of Hawthorne and south of Burnside would move to Abernethy. Half of the neighborhood goes to Sunnyside K-5: Students living north of Burnside would move to an updated Sunnyside K-5.

What could students gain?

Better, safer classrooms: Moving to Abernethy and Sunnyside means learning in updated buildings with better resources and learning spaces.

More support and activities: Combining school communities gives students access to more classmates, full-time staff, and steady classroom support.

Support over time: Bringing students together creates larger, stronger schools that keep their funding and programs reliable over time.

What else was considered?

Building condition over size: Even though Buckman is a larger building than Abernethy, Buckman’s building repair needs are severe. Title I Funding Support: District teams considered Buckman’s Title I status carefully to ensure students moving to receiving schools continue to get strong learning and family support services.

What about special education?

As we combine school communities with distinct Special Education programming, we are carefully planning each step to ensure tailored, continuous support throughout the transition. Students who receive specialized programming in a closing school will be assigned a new location for their IEP-identified services. Buckman is currently a regional site for special education Social Emotional Skills programming. Students served in the Social Emotional Skills classroom in the K–2 or 3–5 grade bands at Buckman will receive their services in dedicated SES classrooms at Sunnyside Elementary School.

BUCKMAN

ENROLLMENT, PROGRAMS & MAPS

How many students are expected?

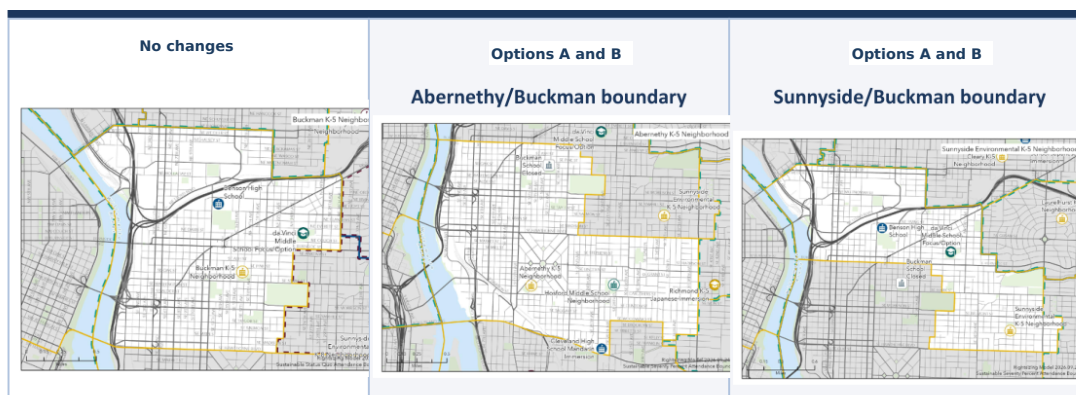
School year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
No changes	244	245	248	246	239

Options A and B: The Buckman facility closes. The Buckman community joins with the Abernethy and Sunnyside communities.

Programs, school size & nearby families

Measure	No changes	Options A and B
Type of change	No changes	School would close
Meets school size goal?	No	School would close
Meets space use goal?	No	School would close
Students living within 1 mile	82.0%	School would close
Grades and programs	K-5 neighborhood & choice program	School would close

Where would the school boundary be?



Who would the school serve?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
No changes	36.4%	25.8%	7.1%	29.7%	Yes

Scenarios A and B: School would close